

Corpus of the EU Parliament Debates (EUPDCorp), 1999-2024

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Overview

This is a codebook for the corpus of the parliamentary debates of the European Union Parliament held between 1999 and 2024 (Term 5 - Term 9). Data was collected from the official database of the EU Parliament [link], and further populated using publicly available resources. The corpus contains 563 696 speeches available in their original languages and in English translation.

Citation Information

If you use this dataset, please cite: Mochtak, Michal (2026): Corpus of the EU Parliament Debates (EUPDCorp), 1999-2024, Zenodo, v2.0, <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.15056399>.

Acknowledgment

The creation of the dataset was supported by the Radboud Excellence Fellowship [Grant No. 2702184].

Variables

doc_id

Document ID. [*numeric*]

file

Original data file name retrieved from the EP database. [*character*]

term_no

Official numerical identifier for consecutive terms.. The dataset covers five full terms (5th - 9th). [*numeric*]

date

Date of a speech. [*numeric*]

datemonth

Year and month of a speech, e.g, “200907”. [*numeric*]

year

Year of a speech. [*numeric*]

agenda

Agenda point retrieved from original documents (various EU languages). [*character*]

firstname

MEP’s first name. [*character*]

lastname

MEP’s last name. [*character*]

country

MEP’s country of origin. [*character*]

language

Language of the presented speech. [*character*]

nationality

MEP’s nationality. [*character*]

gender

Gender: (F) for female, (M) for male. [*character*]

birth__year

Year of birth. [*numeric*]

birth__place

Place of birth. [*character*]

mepid

Unique MEP ID assigned by the EP [*numeric*]

moderator

Dummy variable indicating the moderator's role; the person announcing an agenda point. The moderator's role is propagated through the speeches of a given agenda slot. [*numeric*]

party_db_code

EPG affiliation as reported in the original documents (reported as "party"). This variable is dynamic and might change through term. It is a snapshot affiliation as reported per MEP per published document. [*character*]

epg_short

Short code referring to parliamentary groups in the EU parliament (EPG) normalized into party families. As the parliamentary groups/fractions go through changes (e.g. names, compositions), the normalized codes groups them into fraction streams that can be mapped through time.

Code	Group
IND	Independent
NAT	Union for Europe of the Nations / Europe of Democracies and Diversities / Independence/Democracy / Europe of Freedom and [Direct] Democracy / Europe of Nations and Freedom / Identity and Democracy
GUENGL	European United Left - Nordic Green Left
ALDERE	Alliance of Liberals and Democrats for Europe / Renew Europe
EPP	European People's Party
SOCPEPASD	Socialist Group / Party of European Socialists / Progressive Alliance of Socialists and Democrats
GEFA	The Greens / European Free Alliance
ECR	European Conservatives and Reformists

epg_long

Full name referring to parliamentary groups in the EU parliament (EPG) normalized into party families. See the table above for full Group names in the column "Group". [*character*]

epg_partyfacts_id

Unique Party Facts ID for EPGs. [*numeric*]

party_name

Full national level party name extracted from the MEP database: Sébastien Michon. (2021). Directory of the European Parliament members (1.0.0) [Data set]. Zenodo. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.5036957>. The merge was done based on a unique mepid as a shared column. [*character*]

partyfacts_id

Unique Party Facts ID for national parties mapped from the MEP database: Sébastien Michon. (2021). Directory of the European Parliament members (1.0.0) [Data set]. Zenodo. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.5036957>. [*numeric*]

ches_id

Unique identifier for each party from Chapel Hill Expert Survey (CHES). CHES_IDs were extracted from the V-Party dataset (<https://v-dem.net/data/v-party-dataset/>) using partyfacts_id and its linkage to PartyFacts database. [*numeric*]

gps_id

Unique identifier for each party in the Global Party Survey (GPS) dataset. GPS_IDs were extracted from the V-Party dataset (<https://v-dem.net/data/v-party-dataset/>) using partyfacts_id and its linkage to PartyFacts database. [*numeric*]

speech

Original speech as presented in the European Parliament (various EU languages). [*character*]

speech_en

Translated version of the original speech to English. Speeches were machine-translated using the nllb-200-distilled-600M model developed by Meta (available at: <https://huggingface.co/facebook/nllb-200-distilled-600M>). [*character*]

imputed

A dummy variable (0/1) indicates whether biographical and party information for MEPs was imputed. Due to the integration of multiple datasets and formats, not all variables are available across all terms. However, because mepid is a unique cross-term identifier, some missing values were populated from other complete entries. This process affected approximately 4% of the data points.